

WHAT YOU NEED BEFORE YOU START

Before diving into Figma, take a few minutes to prepare. This will save you significant time during the wireframing process.

- **A free Figma account** – Sign up at figma.com if you have not already.
- **A rough idea of your page structure** – Know what sections your page needs (header, hero, features, footer, etc.).
- **Content priorities** – Decide what information is most important for the user to see first.
- **Reference wireframes (optional)** – Browse Figma's community for wireframe kits or examples to get inspired.

STEP-BY-STEP: HOW TO CREATE A WIREFRAME IN FIGMA

STEP 1: CREATE A NEW FIGMA FILE

Open Figma and click “**New design file**” from your dashboard. This gives you a blank canvas to work with. Rename the file something descriptive like “Homepage Wireframe v1” so you can find it later.

STEP 2: SET UP YOUR FRAME

In Figma, a **Frame** acts as your artboard. It defines the screen size you are designing for.

1. Press the shortcut key **F** on your keyboard (or select the Frame tool from the top toolbar).
2. On the right-hand panel, you will see preset frame sizes. For a standard desktop website wireframe, choose “**Desktop**” which is typically set to 1440 x 1024 pixels.
3. If you are wireframing for mobile, select a phone preset like “iPhone 16” or similar.

Tip: You can always resize your frame later by dragging its edges or changing the dimensions in the right panel.

STEP 3: BUILD A SIMPLE GRID LAYOUT

Grids help you align elements consistently across the page. Setting one up takes just a few seconds.

1. Select your frame by clicking on it.
2. In the right panel under “**Layout grid**”, click the “**+**” icon.
3. Click the grid icon that appears and change the type to “**Columns**”.
4. Set the count to **12** (the standard for web design), with a margin of about **80px** and a gutter of **20px**.

This 12-column grid gives you a flexible foundation for placing content blocks. You can toggle the grid visibility on and off with **Ctrl + G** (or Cmd + G on Mac).

STEP 4: CREATE THE HEADER SECTION

The header is the first thing users see. Keep it simple in your wireframe.

1. Select the **Rectangle tool** (shortcut: **R**).
2. Draw a rectangle across the top of your frame, roughly 1440px wide and 80px tall.
3. Fill it with a light gray color (like **#E0E0E0**) to represent the header background.
4. Add a **text element** (shortcut: **T**) on the left side and type “Logo” as a placeholder.
5. On the right side, add another text element with placeholder navigation items like “Home | About | Services | Contact”.

Remember, wireframes are intentionally plain. You are not choosing real fonts or colors yet.

STEP 5: DESIGN THE HERO SECTION

The hero section sits just below the header and typically contains the main headline, a subheading, and a call-to-action button.

1. Draw a large rectangle below the header, roughly 1440px wide and 500px tall. Fill it with a slightly different shade of gray.
2. Add a large text element for the **headline**. Type something like “Main Headline Goes Here” in a larger font size (32-48px).
3. Below it, add a smaller text element for the **subheading**: “Supporting text that explains the value proposition.”
4. Draw a small rounded rectangle to represent a **CTA button**. Add text inside it like “Get Started”.
5. To represent an image placeholder, draw a rectangle on one side and add an “X” from corner to corner using the **Line tool** (shortcut: **L**). This is the universal symbol for a placeholder image in wireframes.

STEP 6: ADD CONTENT SECTIONS

Most website wireframes include several content blocks below the hero. Here are common sections you can add:

Section	What to Include	Layout Suggestion
Features / Services	3-4 icon placeholders with short text labels	3 or 4 column grid
About / Description	Text block on one side, image placeholder on the other	2 column split
Testimonials	Quote text, name, small circle for avatar	Centered or 3 column
Call to Action	Headline, brief text, and a button	Centered, full-width
Footer	Logo, links, copyright text	3 or 4 column grid

For each section:

1. Draw a full-width rectangle as the section background.
2. Use smaller rectangles, circles, and text to represent content within the section.
3. Keep spacing consistent between sections (40-80px is a good range).

STEP 7: USE AUTO LAYOUT FOR CLEANER STRUCTURE

Figma's **Auto Layout** feature is a game-changer, even at the wireframe stage. It lets you create responsive groups of elements that automatically adjust when you add or remove items.

1. Select multiple elements (for example, three feature cards).
2. Press **Shift + A** to wrap them in an Auto Layout frame.
3. In the right panel, adjust the spacing between items, padding, and direction (horizontal or vertical).

Auto Layout keeps your wireframe neat and makes it much easier to rearrange sections later.

STEP 8: USE COMPONENTS FOR REPEATING ELEMENTS

If you have elements that repeat (like navigation bars, cards, or buttons), turn them into **components**.

1. Select the element you want to reuse.
2. Right-click and choose “**Create component**” (or press Ctrl + Alt + K / Cmd + Option + K).
3. Now you can copy instances of this component across your wireframe. If you update the main component, all instances update automatically.

This is especially useful if your wireframe spans multiple pages.

STEP 9: ADD BASIC ANNOTATIONS (OPTIONAL BUT RECOMMENDED)

Annotations help other people understand your wireframe without you being there to explain it.

- Use small text labels outside the frame to explain functionality. For example: “This button opens a sign-up modal.”
- Use a distinct color (like blue or red) for annotation text so it stands out from wireframe content.
- You can also use Figma’s built-in **comment feature** (shortcut: **C**) to leave notes directly on the canvas for collaborators.

STEP 10: REVIEW, SHARE, AND ITERATE

Once your wireframe is complete:

1. **Review it yourself** by scrolling through and asking: Does this layout make sense? Is the most important content visible first? Is the user flow logical?
2. **Share the file** by clicking the “Share” button in the top right corner. You can invite collaborators by email or generate a view-only link.
3. **Gather feedback** using Figma’s comment tools or by presenting the wireframe in a meeting.
4. **Iterate** based on feedback. Wireframes are meant to be changed quickly, so do not be afraid to move things around.

BEST PRACTICES FOR WIREFRAMING IN FIGMA

Following a few simple rules will help you create wireframes that are clear, useful, and easy to build upon.

- **Keep visual styling minimal.** Stick to grayscale. Avoid gradients, shadows, or detailed images. The focus should be on layout and content hierarchy.
- **Use no more than two fonts.** One for headings and one for body text is plenty at this stage.
- **Represent images with placeholder boxes.** A gray rectangle with an “X” through it is the standard convention.
- **Name your layers.** This might seem tedious, but it makes your file much easier to navigate, especially when sharing with others. Double-click a layer in the left panel to rename it.
- **Group related elements.** Select items that belong together and press Ctrl + G (Cmd + G) to group them. This keeps your layers panel organized.
- **Design for content first, decoration later.** Ask yourself what information the user needs on this page and place that content before thinking about anything visual.

USING FIGMA’S AI WIREFRAME TOOLS IN 2026

Figma has introduced AI-powered features that can speed up wireframing significantly. With **Figma Make** and the **AI Wireframe Generator**, you can now describe what you need in plain language and get a starting wireframe in seconds.

Here is how to use it:

1. Open a new Figma file and create a frame.
2. Access the AI wireframe tool from the toolbar or the plugins menu.
3. Type a prompt describing your page. For example: “Landing page with a hero section, three feature cards, a testimonial slider, and a footer.”
4. Figma generates a wireframe layout based on your description.
5. Customize the result by moving, resizing, or replacing elements as needed.

AI wireframing is a fantastic starting point, but **you should always review and adjust the output**. The AI does not know your specific users, business goals, or content strategy. Use it as a time-saver, not a replacement for thoughtful design decisions.

HOW TO CONNECT WIREFRAMES FOR MULTI-PAGE FLOWS

If your project has multiple pages (like a homepage, about page, and contact page), you will want to connect your wireframes to show user flow.

1. Create separate frames for each page on the same Figma canvas.
2. Switch to the **Prototype** tab in the right panel.
3. Select a button or link element on your wireframe.
4. Drag the blue connection handle to the target frame (the page that button should navigate to).
5. Press the **Play** button in the top right corner to preview the flow in Figma's presentation mode.

This is an excellent way to test navigation logic before you invest time in high-fidelity design.

FREE FIGMA WIREFRAME KITS WORTH EXPLORING

You do not have to build everything from scratch. Figma's community offers free wireframe kits that include pre-built components like headers, footers, card layouts, form elements, and more. To find them:

1. Go to the **Figma Community** (community.figma.com).
2. Search for "wireframe kit" or "website wireframe."
3. Duplicate a kit you like into your drafts.
4. Copy and paste components from the kit into your wireframe file.

Using a kit can cut your wireframing time in half, especially if you are still learning the tool.

COMMON WIREFRAMING MISTAKES BEGINNERS SHOULD AVOID

- **Adding too much detail too early.** Wireframes are not mockups. Resist the urge to pick perfect colors or real images at this stage.
- **Ignoring mobile layouts.** If your website needs to be responsive, create a separate mobile wireframe alongside your desktop version.
- **Skipping real content placeholders.** "Lorem ipsum" is fine for body text, but use realistic headlines and labels. This helps stakeholders understand the page better.

- **Not getting feedback early.** Share your wireframe before moving to high-fidelity design. It is much cheaper to change a wireframe than a polished mockup.
- **Forgetting about scroll depth.** Make sure the most critical content appears above the fold (the area visible without scrolling).

FROM WIREFRAME TO HIGH-FIDELITY DESIGN

Once your wireframe is approved, you can use it as the foundation for a high-fidelity mockup right inside Figma. Here is a simple transition process:

1. **Duplicate your wireframe file** so you always have the original to reference.
2. **Replace placeholder text** with real copy.
3. **Swap gray rectangles** for actual images and icons.
4. **Apply your brand colors, typography, and spacing** according to your design system or style guide.
5. **Add interactive elements** in the Prototype tab to create a clickable prototype for user testing.

The beauty of starting with a wireframe is that the structure is already solid. You are simply dressing it up.

References:

<https://www.j-a-b.net/how-to-create-a-wireframe-in-figma-step-by-step-guide-for-beginners/>

On YouTube:

[How to Create a Website Wireframe in Figma \(Beginner Tutorial\)](#)

[How to Wireframe in Figma in 2026](#)